Asset & Transport Development Management
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**Transport Development Management**

# Memo

To: Planning Services
From: Transport Development Management
Date: 2nd December 2025

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**Application Number:** S/RES/25/1389

**Proposal:** Reserved matters application (access, appearance, layout, scale and landscaping) for 122 dwellings and associated infrastructure -Reserved Matters from previous outline permission S/OUT/13/1555.

**Location:** Parcels R1-R2, New Eastern Villages, Swindon, Wiltshire

Thank you for inviting Highways & Transport comment on the above application for approval of reserved matters, following the grant of permission, in outline, for new residential development within the village of South Marston.

The application is supported by a range of documents, which I will refer to where relevant to me on behalf of the Local Highway Authority.

Means of Access

The proposed development is illustrated on the Planning Layout (drawing no. SW192-PD-001 Rev. N). The layout comprises three parcels positioned either side of the Secondary Street, which is subject to a separate Reserved Matters Application (RMA). A larger parcel is situated to the west of the Secondary Street, with two smaller parcels located to the east.

Access to the development is proposed through a range of arrangements. Most notable are the two 5m wide bellmouth junctions serving the western parcel. In addition, shared vehicular crossovers and direct plot accesses are proposed to serve the wider site.

The Reserved Matters Application (RMA) for the Secondary Street is yet to be determined. Accordingly, any access taken from this route must demonstrate that adequate visibility splays can be achieved in accordance with the guidance set out in Manual for Streets (MfS). No plans within the current submission provide evidence of such visibility. Furthermore, no evidence has been provided to show that vehicles can enter and exit the direct and shared accesses without overrunning adjacent verges or highway margins. On this basis, the proposal fails to demonstrate that safe and suitable access can be delivered.

It is essential that the access arrangements proposed under this application are consistent with those to be determined for the Secondary Street. With reference to the latest submission for the Secondary Street, I note that the applications are not currently consistent. This inconsistency must be addressed to secure a coherent and safe design across the wider development.

Although outside of the application boundary, concern is raised regarding the siting of visitor parking bays along the Secondary Street and the potential impact this may have on the visibility available to drivers when

exiting their spaces. The current submission does not demonstrate that such parking can operate safely without obstructing sightlines, and further clarification is required.

A Stage 1 Road Safety Audit (RSA) together with a Designer's Response must be submitted to support this RMA. The RSA must also consider the proposed access arrangements onto the Secondary Street and confirm how any identified issues will be addressed.

Pedestrian access to the wider development is facilitated by 2m wide footways provided on both sides of the Secondary Street carriageway. These footways extend into the western parcel.

While the proposals broadly reflect the requirements of the approved Strategic Design Code (SDC) and Character Area Design Code (CADC), the application fails to resolve several technical and design matters, which are outlined in detail below.

Internal Site Layout

The Local Highway Authority (LHA) requires the internal road network to be delivered as a 20mph zone, with appropriate speed management features incorporated. The proposed use of 'rumble strips' is not considered an effective traffic calming measure for achieving and maintaining speeds at or below 20mph. Amendments to the layout must therefore be sought to secure compliance with this requirement.

The Engineering plan (drawing no. SW192-EN-401) confirms that visibility commensurate with a 20mph speed limit is achieved at the internal junctions. However, the visibility splays at the access located between Plots 234 and 241 appear to extend beyond the back of the footway. Any land over which visibility extends must be included within the public highway, and any proposed planting must be appropriate to safeguard visibility.

The plan indicates that forward visibility of 17m is achieved at the bend near Plot 167. This falls short of the minimum 25m requirement for a 20mph design speed and is therefore inadequate. The layout must be amended to ensure compliance with forward visibility standards.

Several private drives are proposed. However, an area of 'Grasscrete' connects two of these, providing through access to 8 dwellings (Plots 235–239, 240, 248 and 249). This exceeds the threshold at which adoptable design standards must be applied. In such cases, 'shared streets' must be provided with a minimum clear width of 6 m, a 1 m grassed verge to accommodate street lighting, and an entry treatment and surface that clearly identifies pedestrian priority. The current layout must therefore be amended to achieve compliance.

The applicant should also be advised that Swindon Borough Council will not adopt permeable paving. Any areas proposed with such surfacing must therefore remain private and outside the scope of adoption.

The approved SDC requires tertiary streets to include a 2m wide footway on both sides of the carriageway. The proposed layout does not comply with this requirement and must be amended to provide the necessary footways.

Swept path analysis (drawing no. SW192-EN-203 A) has been submitted to demonstrate that a 10.6m refuse vehicle can traverse the layout, entering and exiting in a forward gear. However, the analysis indicates that the body of the vehicle overhangs the footway adjacent to Plot 257, where a pedestrian crossing is proposed, and the visitor parking bay opposite Plot 162. The plan also shows the refuse vehicle reversing into a private area. The applicant should be advised that Swindon Borough Council will not provide servicing from a private road without prior agreement. The layout must therefore be amended to ensure safe and adoptable access arrangements.

Additional swept path analysis (drawing no. SW192-EN-204) confirms that emergency servicing can be accommodated within the site layout.

Several pedestrian crossing points are illustrated on the Engineering Plan (drawing no. SW192-EN-401). An additional pedestrian crossing is required in the vicinity of the junction between Roads 2 and 7, to facilitate onward access to the potential pedestrian connection in the northwest of the site. The layout must therefore be amended to incorporate this crossing.

Two further pedestrian connections are proposed: one to potential development in the west and one into Oxleaze Wood. The LHA shares the concerns raised by South Marston Parish Council that the route to the Oxleaze Wood access will not form part of the adopted highway. The applicant must clarify the long-term management and maintenance arrangements for this route.

Parking and Cycle Storage

The Parking strategy for the site is illustrated in the Parking Plan (drawing no. SW192-SL-050 A). Allocated parking is provided in accordance with the adopted Parking Standards and approved design codes. However, as noted above, concerns are raised regarding the impact of the visitor parking bays along the Secondary Street.

Additional swept path and visibility assessment is required to demonstrate that the parking bays serving Plots 184–189 and 202–207 will operate safely. The comments made by South Marston Parish Council regarding reversing manoeuvres are acknowledged; however, on an unclassified street subject to a 20 mph limit such manoeuvres may be acceptable provided adequate visibility is achieved. The applicant must submit evidence confirming safe operation of these bays.

Thirty-one visitor parking spaces are proposed to serve the development. While the quantity of parking is sufficient to meet the requirements of the Parking Standards, concerns are raised regarding the siting and design.

Eight visitor parking spaces are shown on the Secondary Street, which lies outside the boundary of this application. While no objection in principle is raised, that application is yet to be determined and the number and location of spaces remain unconfirmed. Reliance on this provision is therefore premature, and the applicant must demonstrate that adequate visitor parking can be secured within the scope of this application.

The remainder of the visitor parking spaces are proposed within adoptable or private areas. Where streets are to be offered for adoption, the width of the hardstanding surrounding visitor parking bays must be increased to 2m. In private areas, the width of hardstanding should be a minimum of 1.2m to ensure inclusive access in line with best practice.

Cycle storage is proposed within garages where provided, or within rear gardens where garages are absent. These arrangements are consistent with the adopted Parking Standards.

Other Matters

There are currently no proposals for vehicular access into Manor Farm. Although a desire to safeguard potential future development is noted, the nature and extent of such development are presently undefined. In the absence of this detail, the appropriateness of any access arrangements cannot be determined. Any subsequent planning application for Manor Farm will need to satisfy the LHA that a safe and suitable means of access is provided.

In summary, the LHA has a number of concerns regarding the proposals. Before I am able to recommend that no objection be raised, the applicant must address the following matters through amendments and the submission of additional information:

- Demonstrate that all accesses achieve visibility in accordance with MfS, with land included in the public highway where required.
- Ensure access arrangements align with those submitted for the Secondary Street.
- Submit a Stage 1 RSA which also covers the proposed access arrangements onto the Secondary Street, together with a Designer's Response confirming how identified issues will be addressed
- Replace rumble strips with effective traffic calming measures to secure compliance with a 20mph zone.
- Amend layout to achieve the minimum 25m forward visibility requirement at the bend near Plot 167.
- Redesign the private drive serving 8 dwellings to meet adoptable standards.
- Amend tertiary streets to provide 2m wide footways on both sides of the carriageway, in line with the Strategic Design Code.
- Revise layout to prevent refuse vehicles overhanging footways or reversing into private areas.
- Incorporate an additional crossing near the junction of Roads 2 and 7 to facilitate onward access.
- Clarify long-term management and maintenance arrangements for the pedestrian route into Oxleaze wood.
- Provide swept path and visibility assessment to demonstrate safe operation of parking bays for Plots 184–189 and 202–207.
- Demonstrate adequate provision of visitor parking within the application boundary, as reliance on spaces shown on the Secondary Street is premature.
- Increase the width of hardstanding surrounding visitor parking bays to 2m where streets are to be adopted and 1.2m in private areas.

Until the above amendments are made and additional information provided, I have no alternative but to recommend that the application is **refused**, for reasons that I will formalise should it become necessary.

Please note that the comments made here represent Officer opinion and cannot be seen to prejudice Swindon Borough Council's formal determination in relation to any application or planning matter.

**Informative:**
Notwithstanding the submitted drawings, any areas to be dedicated for adoption will be agreed by the Local Highway Authority during the Technical Approval process.

Kind Regards,
Chelsey

**Chelsey Lucas**
**Senior Transport Development Management Engineer**

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